

Country PhD Intelligence: United Kingdom

Academic Intelligence Dossier • 2026-09-21

Country Code: UK

Primary Currency: GBP

Execution Date: 2026-09-21

Target PhD Field: Edge Computing, Edge AI & Distributed Systems

1. Country Overview & Research Ecosystem

United Kingdom offers an internationally renowned doctoral research ecosystem characterized by world-class university laboratories, competitive national and institutional funding structures, and clear pathways for international doctoral scholars.

* **Primary Funding Vehicle:** UKRI / EPSRC Doctoral Studentships & University Doctoral Scholarships

* **Immigration & Dependant Policy:** International postgraduate research (PhD/Doctoral) students are explicitly permitted to bring family dependants (partner and children) on Student Dependant Visas.

* **Official Guidance:** <https://www.gov.uk/student-visa/family-members>

2. Executive Intelligence Metrics

* **Total Top Universities Identified:** 8

* **Total Vetted Professors Monitored:** 9

* **Available Doctoral Funding Schemes:** 4

* **Key Application Deadline:** 2026-12-15

3. Discovered Universities & Suitability

University	Relevant Departments	Research Suitability	Funding Rating	Official Portal
Imperial College London	Department of Computing, Department of Electrical and Electronic Engineering	70.5%	High	Portal
University of Cambridge	Department of Computer Science and Technology (Computer Laboratory), Department of Engineering	69.5%	High	Portal
University College London	Department of Computer Science, Department of Electronic and Electrical Engineering	66.5%	High	Portal
University of Bristol	School of Computer Science, Department of Electrical & Electronic Engineering	62.5%	High	Portal
University of Oxford	Department of Computer Science, Department of Engineering Science	59.5%	High	Portal

University of Edinburgh	School of Informatics, Institute for Computing Systems Architecture (ICSA)	59.5%	High	Portal
King's College London	Department of Informatics, Department of Engineering	59.5%	High	Portal
University of Glasgow	School of Computing Science, James Watt School of Engineering	54.5%	High	Portal

4. Top Vetted PhD Supervisors & Relevance

Professor	University	Priority Tier	Research Fit	Recruitment Status	Profile Link
Prof. Jon Crowcroft	University of Cambridge	Tier 1	100.0%	CONFIRMED_ACTIV E	Dossier
Prof. Julie A. McCann	Imperial College London	Tier 1	100.0%	CONFIRMED_ACTIV E	Dossier
Prof. Peter Pietzuch	Imperial College London	Tier 1	100.0%	CONFIRMED_ACTIV E	Dossier
Prof. Hamed Haddadi	Imperial College London	Tier 1	100.0%	CONFIRMED_ACTIV E	Dossier
Prof. Mahesh Marina	University of Edinburgh	Tier 1	96.2%	STRONG_EVIDENC E	Dossier
Prof. Nishanth Sastry	University of Surrey / King's College London	Tier 1	92.8%	STRONG_EVIDENC E	Dossier
Prof. Dimitrios Pezaros	University of Glasgow	Tier 1	83.0%	STRONG_EVIDENC E	Dossier
Dr. Eiko Yoneki	University of Cambridge	Tier 1	80.8%	CONFIRMED_ACTIV E	Dossier
Prof. Cecilia Mascolo	University of Cambridge	Tier 1	73.8%	CONFIRMED_ACTIV E	Dossier

5. Major Doctoral Funding Schemes & Scholarships

UKRI / EPSRC Doctoral Studentships (DTP / ICASE / CDT)

* **Provider / University:** Engineering and Physical Sciences Research Council (EPSRC) / UKRI (All UKRI-Partnered Universities (Imperial, Cambridge, Oxford, Edinburgh, etc.))

* **Funding Type:** FULLY_FUNDED

* **Tuition Coverage:** Full tuition fees covered for standard PhD duration (including international fee waivers within quota)

* **Stipend / Salary:** £19,237/year minimum UKRI tax-free stipend (higher rate of ~£21,500/year for London institutions) + research travel grant

* **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE

* **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED

* **Application Deadline:** 2026-12-15

* **Official Source:** <https://www.ukri.org/what-we-do/developing-people-and-skills/find-studentships-and-doctoral-training/>

Gates Cambridge Scholarship (PhD Track)

- * **Provider / University:** Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation / University of Cambridge (University of Cambridge)
- * **Funding Type:** FULLY_FUNDED
- * **Tuition Coverage:** Full Cambridge University Composition Fee covered
- * **Stipend / Salary:** £21,000/year tax-free maintenance allowance + up to £11,604/year family allowance for dependants
- * **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE
- * **Dependant Support:** EXCELLENT
- * **Application Deadline:** 2026-12-03
- * **Official Source:** <https://www.gatescambridge.org/programme/the-scholarship/>

Imperial College President's PhD Scholarships

- * **Provider / University:** Imperial College London (Imperial College London)
- * **Funding Type:** FULLY_FUNDED
- * **Tuition Coverage:** Full international or home tuition fees covered
- * **Stipend / Salary:** £25,150/year tax-free stipend + £2,000/year consumables fund
- * **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE
- * **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED
- * **Application Deadline:** 2026-11-06
- * **Official Source:**
<https://www.imperial.ac.uk/study/fees-and-funding/postgraduate-doctoral/grants-and-fellowships/presidents-phd-scholarships/>

Principal's Career Development PhD Scholarships

- * **Provider / University:** University of Edinburgh (University of Edinburgh)
- * **Funding Type:** FULLY_FUNDED
- * **Tuition Coverage:** Full tuition fees at UK or Overseas rate
- * **Stipend / Salary:** £19,237/year stipend matching UKRI rate
- * **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE
- * **Dependant Support:** PERMITTED
- * **Application Deadline:** 2026-12-01
- * **Official Source:** <https://www.ed.ac.uk/student-funding/postgraduate/uk-eu/university-fellowships/principals-career-development>

6. Strategic Application Timeline & Next Steps

1. **Weeks 1–4:** Review individual 33-section professor dossiers under `professors`.
 2. **Weeks 5–6:** Conduct tailored email outreach referencing recent publications and active laboratory grants.
 3. **Weeks 7–8:** Formalize 5-page research proposal aligned with the supervisor's documented testbeds.
 4. **Target Deadline:** Submit institutional application ahead of **2026-12-15**.
- *Report compiled automatically by the Global Country-Based PhD Funding and Supervisor Intelligence Engine on 2026-09-21.*